Camera Smudges of Russia

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v1.0.0

Introduction



This document doesn't need much of an introduction, but a few things to keep in mind while reading:

- This includes almost every smudge that has been mapped by Russiacord members
    - Therefore, not all smudges are useful. This is why they have been roughly grouped by their usefulness
- This serves as the next step following seasonal and antenna meta, in my opinion. You certainly can learn about some of these smudges first, especially the major smudges, but some of them are in one specific year or coverage that has a compounding season or car meta clue. Read about car meta here.
- My recommendation if you take nothing else from this document is to **learn the main short antenna smudges**. They are by far the most common and there are relatively few to memorize
    - There are practice maps included at the end for these which I strongly recommend to famliarize yourself with the smudges
- **All smudges are oriented in terms of driving direction**. For example, if I say SW (southwest), it's relative to the direction the car is facing, not cardinally southwest.

Huge thanks to VehicleRonald for providing maps and graphics of many of these smudges.

Major smudges

Main short antenna (2018-2019)

As mentioned above, these are some of the most common and useful smudges in Russia. They can make for instant regionknowing, even if you are unsure about the landscape. Short antenna smudges in 2018 and 2019 will always be B type. The best way to memorize these is to remember what direction they are. You can differentiate B and C easily by the extra dots present in B. The practice maps are linked in the "Resources" section, which I strongly recommend.

Variation A

2018

SE, W

The southwestern coverage is late August/September while the eastern coverage is the middle of summer around July.

Example 1
Example 2

Example 3

2019

SE, W

May coverage with this smudge will be Moscow, east Kostroma, or Sverdlovsk.

Example

Variation B

2018

NW

This one is not particularly useful because the landscape is distinct, but if you struggle with this area you can always check regardless for a triangle in the sky.

Example

2019

NW

Highly useful for NW Krasnodar. Typically if you get it in a more northern climate, Ivanovo is a good send. But given the northern stuff is more urban/suburban, you can middle hedge as well around Nizhny.

Example

Variation C

NW

The most useful smudge from this set.

Example

Variation D

N/NW

Mostly there for confirmation of a blurred antenna. 99% of the time blurred antenna will be easier to see in a no moving game.

Example

Variation E

NE

Can help with Volgograd/Stavropol tilted 50/50.

Example

Alt. short antenna (2018-2019)

Less common smudges for short antenna.

Ingushetia/Grozny

N/NE

I'll also mention that after this smudge near the Grozny/Dagestan border you get a glitchy sun.

Example

Long antenna (2012-2016)

Tuva (2013)

N
The road north of Kyzyl; it starts directly at the border

Example

Zabaykalsky (2013)

N

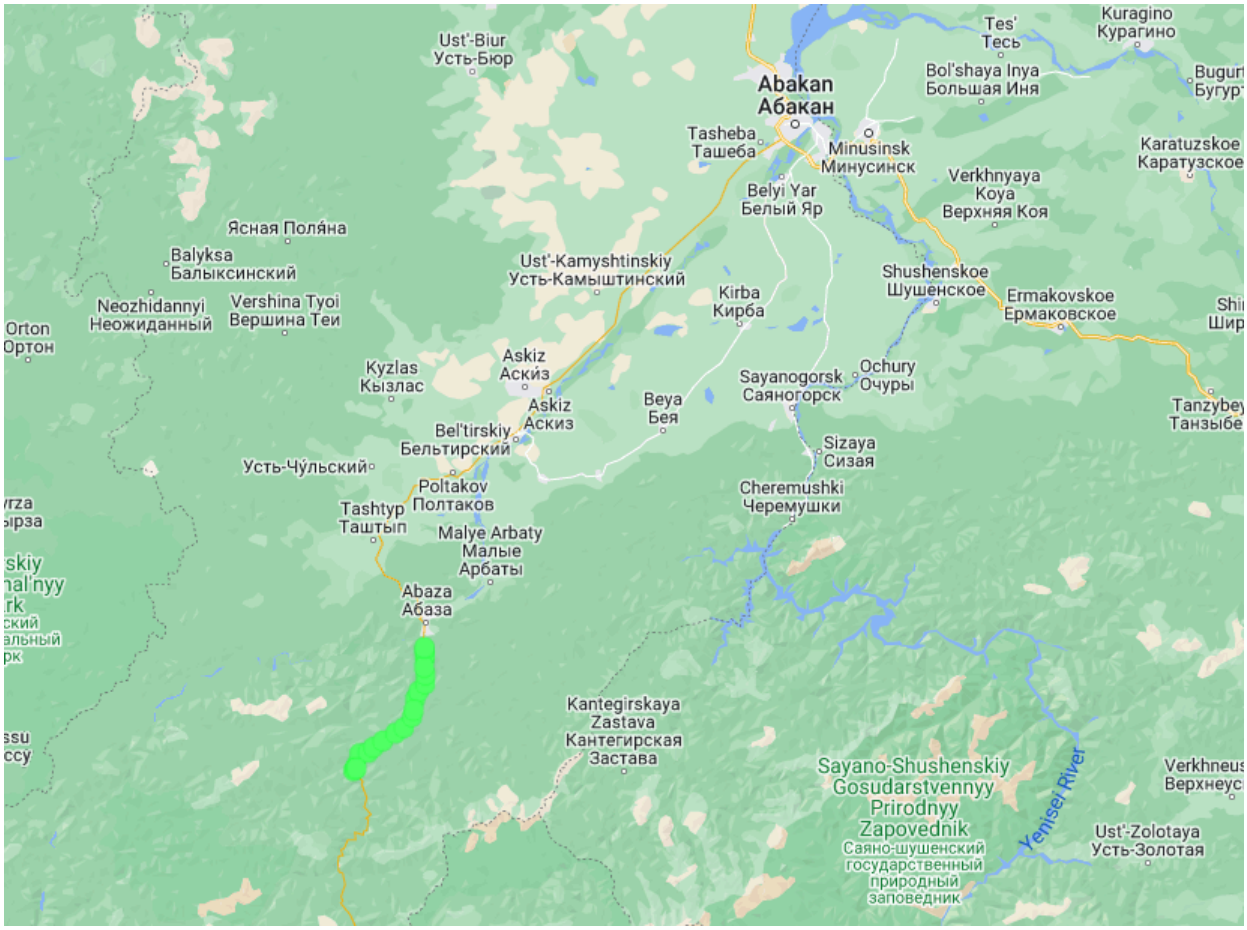
I remember it as east of Aginskoe

Example

Abaza, Khakassia (2013)

N/NE





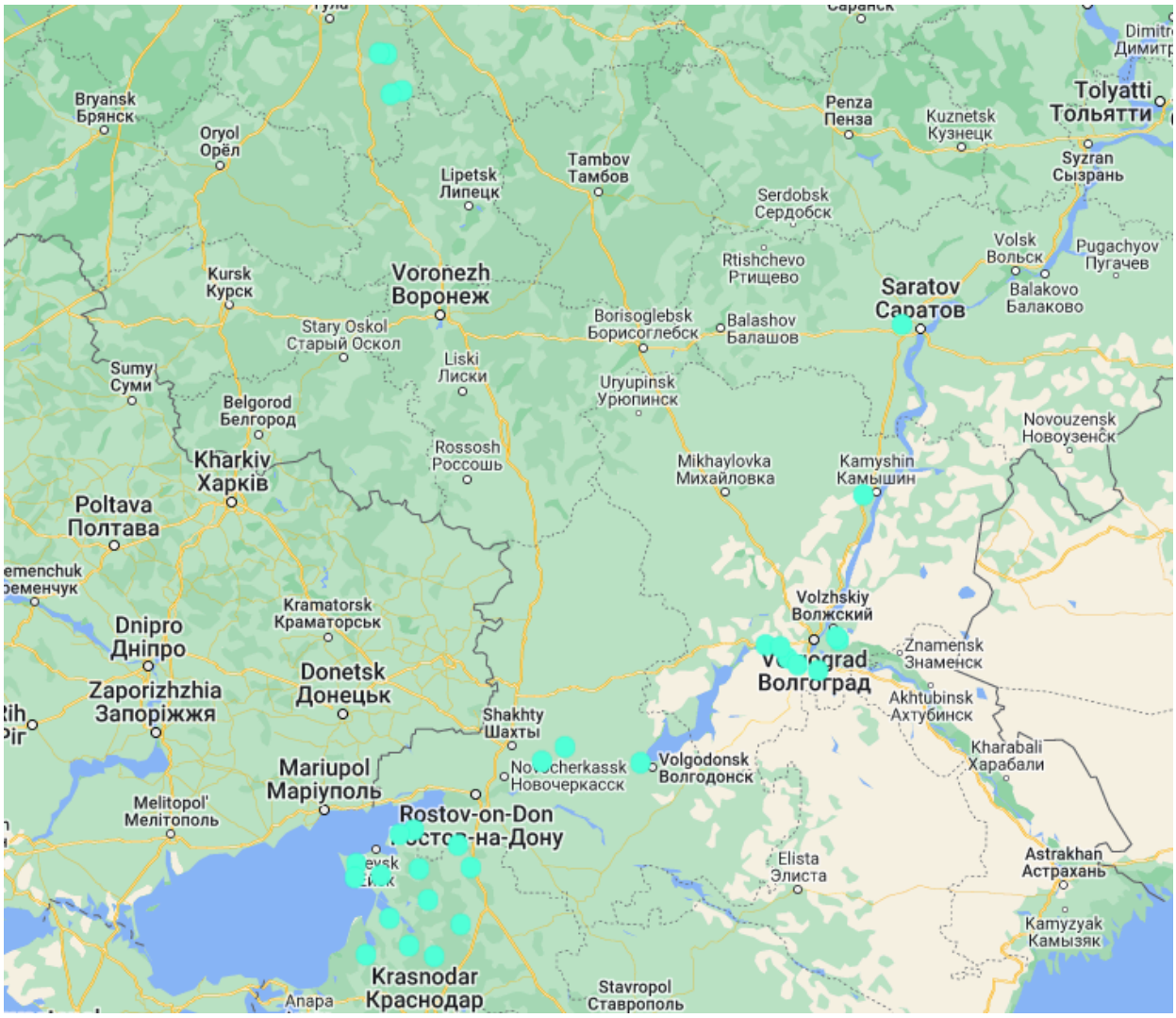
[Example]

Long smudge (2013)

NE

By far most common in NW Krasnodar followed by SE Tula. Most of the other coverage shown on the map is overwritten often.


Settings
100m
-100m



[Example]

Karelia/Vologda (2013)

N

Much more likely to be visible in Karelia than Vologda/Arkhangelsk, but you can certainly still see it.


Settings
100m
-100m

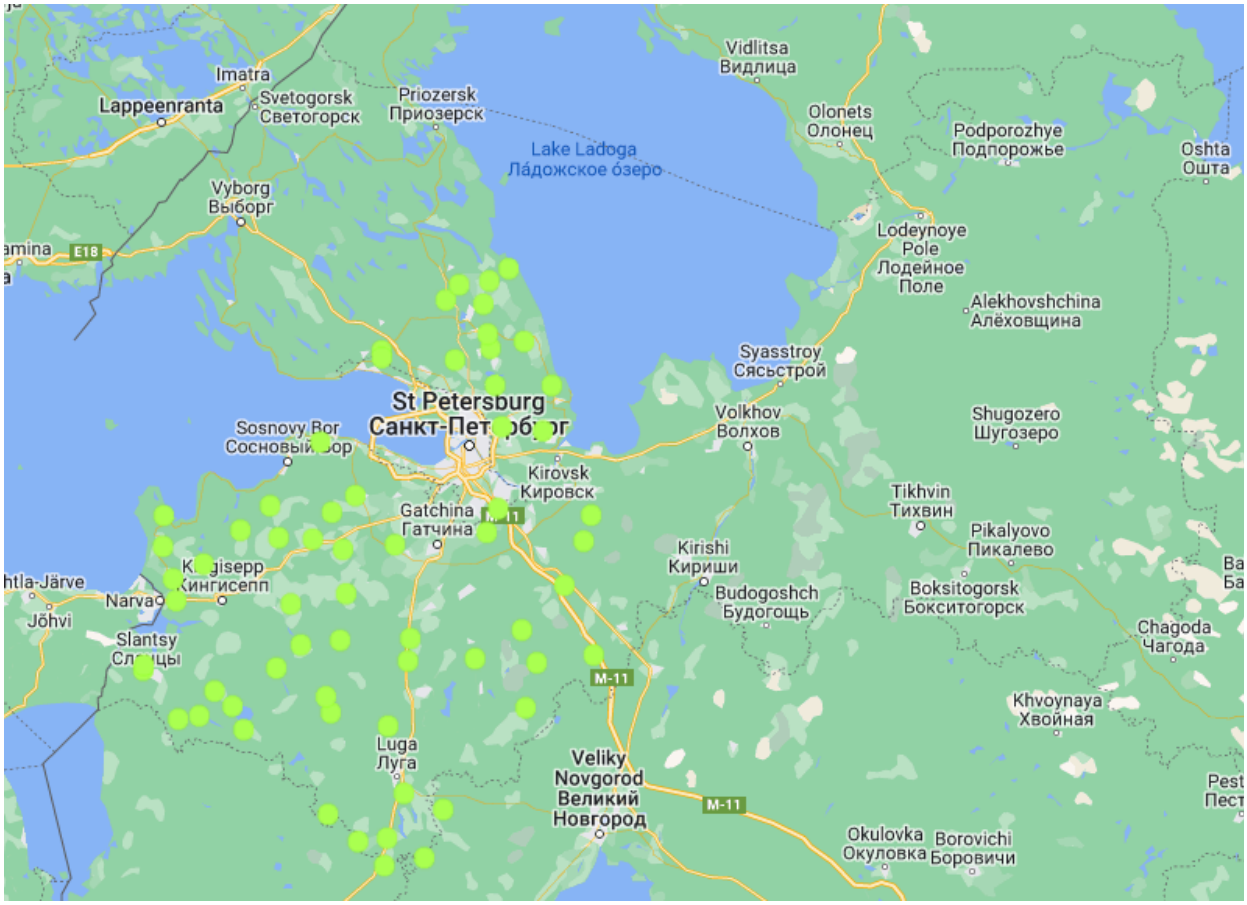
Example

Leningrad (2013)

E

The smudge will accompany A type antenna and summer coverage. Useful for regionguessing.


Settings
100m
-100m


Imatra
Lappeenranta
Svetogorsk
Светогорск
Priozersk
Приозерск
Vidlitsa
Видлица
Olonets
Олонец
Podporozhye
Подпорожье
Oshta
Ошта
Lake Ladoga
Ла́дожское о́зеро
Vyborg
Выборг
E18
Lodeynoye Pole
Лодейное Поле
Alekhovshchina
Алёховщина
Syasstroy
Сясьстрой
St Petersburg
Санкт-Петербург
Sosnovy Bor
Сосновый Бор
Volkhov
Волхов
Shugozero
Шугозеро
Kirovsk
Кировск
Gatchina
Гатчина
Tikhvin
Тихвин
Pikalyovo
Пикалево
Kirishi
Кириши
Budogoshch
Будогощь
Boksitogorsk
Бокситогорск
Narva
Jõhvi
Slantsy
Chagoda
Чагода
M-11
Khvoynaya
Хвойная
Luga
Луга
Veliky Novgorod
Великий Новгород
Okulovka
Окуловка
Borovichi
Боровичи

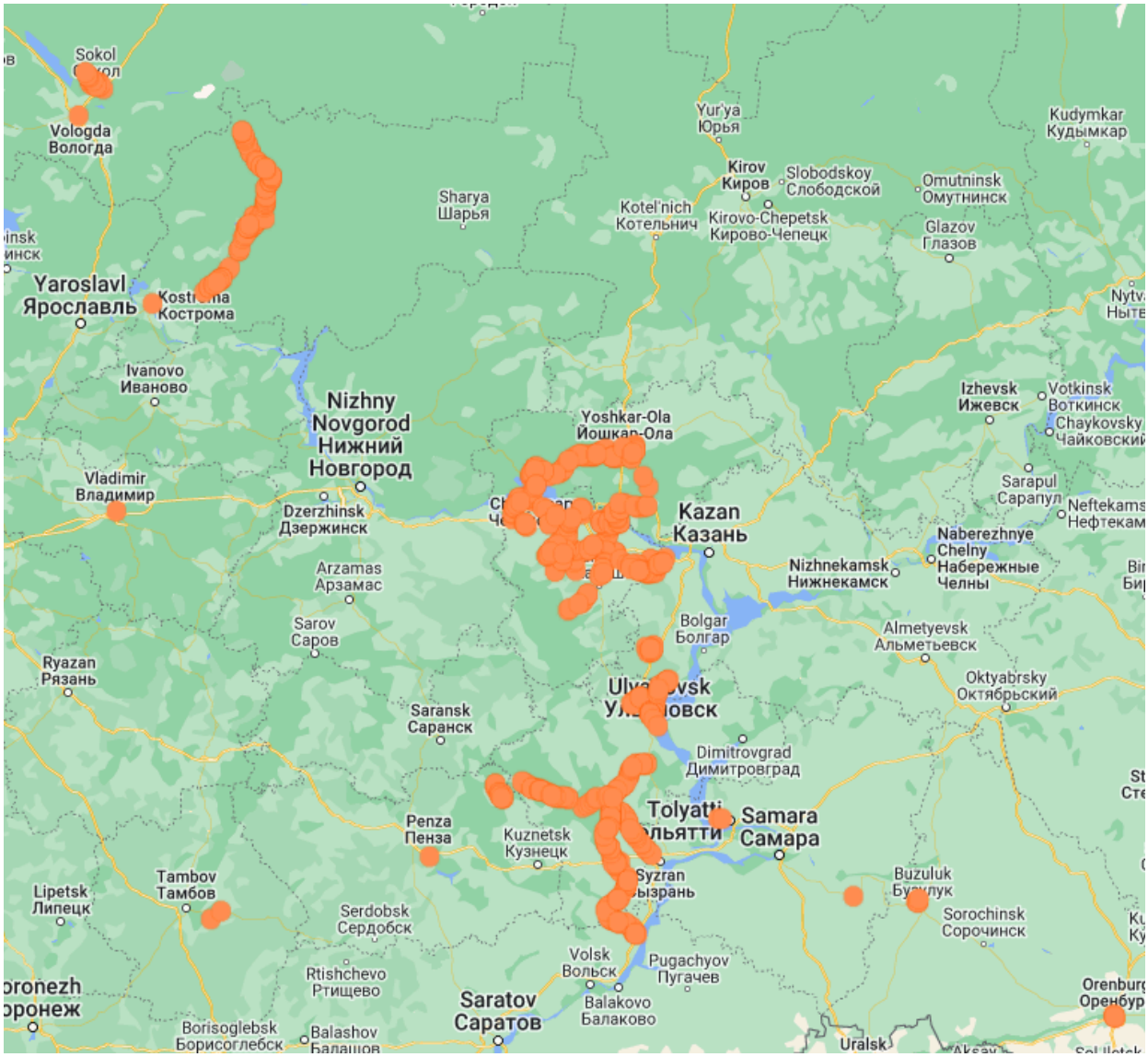
[Example]

Ulyanovsk/Chuvashia (2015)

NW

Exactly the same as the Yaroslavl smudge, but in summer.





[Example]

Gen 4 (2021)

Southern Buryatia red smudge

Most of this coverage was deleted 😕

Example

Minor smudges

Some are free 5Ks if you see them, others are just niche coverages. Some are worth learning if you want to become a Russia expert. They go in chronological order and greatly vary in terms of usefulness, they’re just less useful than the ones mentioned above.

Long antenna (2012-2016)

East of Ostrov (2013)

Example

White car (2013)

Pretty much never useful (also found in southern Chelyabinsk)

Example

Thanks to bluebson for addressing a fix

Chelyabinsk (2013)

W

Hard to see sometimes

Example

Belgorod/Magadan (2013)

NE

No formal map, but NW Belgorod and Magadan both have it in this year. Fairly niche due to cloud presence in Belgorod and Magadan's landscape being sufficient.

Example

Kirov eastern road (2013)

N/NW

Example

West of Sayanogorsk (2013)

Example

North of Surgut (2013)

Example

Mongolia-Zabaykalsky border (2013)

N

Almost useless 👍

Example

Tyumen-Kurgan border splotches (2013)

N

Example

Altai Krai (2013)

W

Example

East of Bratsk (2013)

N

Example

SW of Bratsk (2013)

N

Example

Downtown Chita (2013)

NW

Example

Yaroslavl smudge (2014)

NW

Exactly the same as the Ulyanovsk/Chuvashia smudge, but in October.

Example

Rostov October long antenna (2014)

NE

Free oblast streak most of the time. Same as southern white car but in fall coverage.

Example

Chuvashia (2014)

SW

**Incomplete map*

Example

Western white car (2015)

SW

If you’re somehow in a West vs. Chelya or West vs. Far East 50/50 :tf:

Not really worth learning and often hard to see

Example

Kirov (2015)

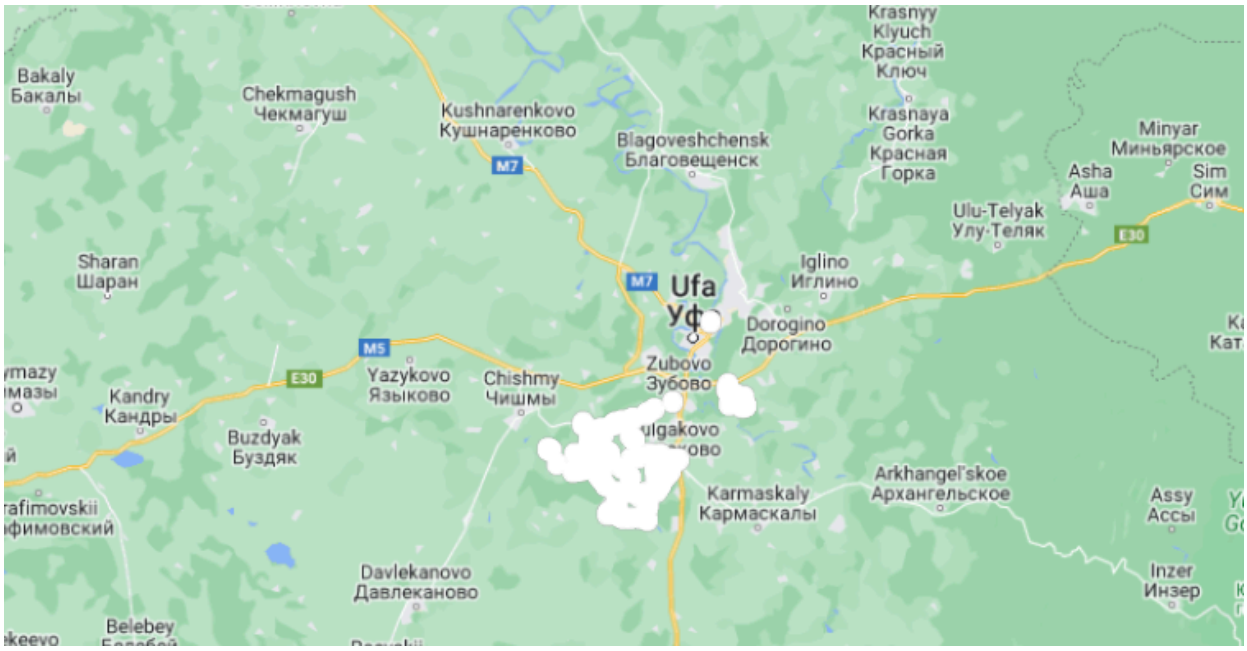
N/NE

Example

Ufa (2015)

SW

White car downtown, quite useful

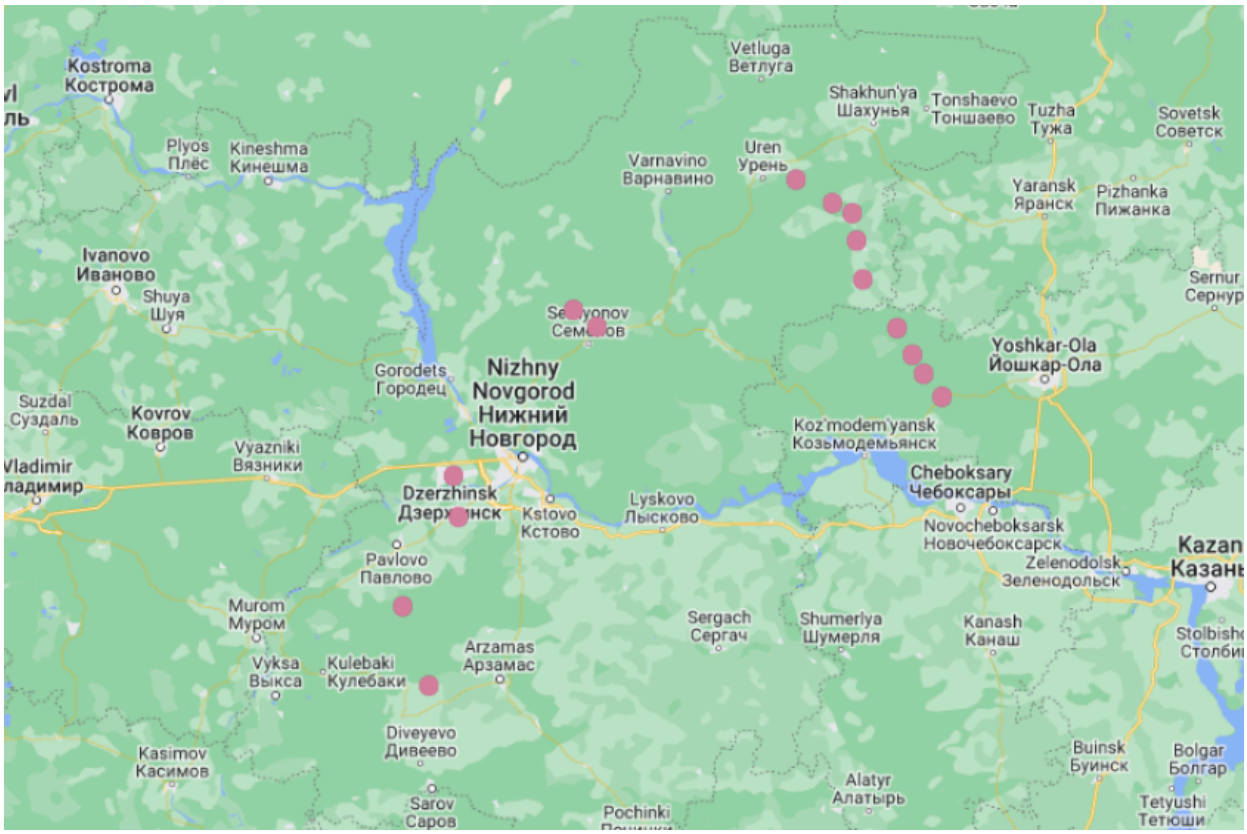


[Example]

Nizhny Novgorod (2015)

W/SW

Extremely hard to see at times


Kostroma
Кострома
Plyos
Плёс
Kineshma
Кинешма
Vetluga
Ветлуга
Shakhun'ya
Шахунья
Tonshaevo
Тоншаево
Tuzha
Тужа
Sovetsk
Советск
Varnavino
Варнавино
Uren
Урень
Yaransk
Яранск
Pizhanka
Пижанка
Ivanovo
Иваново
Shuya
Шуя
Sernur
Сернур
Semyonov
Семёнов
Yoshkar-Ola
Йошкар-Ола
Gorodets
Городец
Nizhny
Novgorod
Нижний
Новгород
Suzdal
Суздаль
Kovrov
Ковров
Koz'modem'yansk
Козьмодемьянск
Vyazniki
Вязники
Vladimir
Владимир
Cheboksary
Чебоксары
Dzerzhinsk
Дзержинск
Kstovo
Кстово
Lyskovo
Лысково
Novocheboksarsk
Новочебоксарск
Zelenodolsk
Зеленодольск
Kazan
Казань
Pavlovo
Павлово
Murom
Муром
Sergach
Сергач
Shumerlya
Шумерля
Kanash
Канаш
Vyksa
Выкса
Kulebaki
Кулебаки
Arzamas
Арзамас
Stolbishe
Столби
Diveyevo
Дивеево
Kasimov
Касимов
Buinsk
Буинск
Bolgar
Болгар
Alatyr
Алатырь
Sarov
Саров
Pochinki
Tetyushi
Тетюши

**Incomplete map*
Example

Southern white car (2015)

NE
Same as Rostov October long antenna, but in summer.

Example

Short antenna (2017-2019)

Western blip downtown (2017)

Above

Example

Novosibirsk-Krasnoyarsk downtown (2017)

Above

Example

Far East downtown (2017)

W

Example

Chelyabinsk (2018)

NW, N/NE

Example pink
Example green

Eastern Sverdlovsk road (2018)

NW

White blurry smudge makes this quite distinct and memorable.

Example

N of Kurgan (2018)

N

Example

Novosibirsk/Altai Krai main road (2018)

N, N/NE

Combining these because they are quite similar. Continues on the main road of Altai Krai towards Altai Republic on the entire road. The Novosibirsk one is direct **N** as shown. The Altai Republic one is **N/NE**.



Example (Novosibirsk)
Example (Altai Krai)

SW of Nazarovo (2018)

NW blurry smudge in very B antenna. Not worth learning.

Example

Tyumen border road (2018)

N/NE

Example

South of Ufa (2018)

N

Example

East of Magnitogorsk (2018)

N

Example

Kursk blur (2018)

N/NE

Example

Rossosh triple smudge (2018)

N

Example

Rostov blur (2018)

Example

NW of Kurgan (2019)

N

Example

Kumertau (2019)

W/NW

South of Sterlitamak

Example

NW of Pyatigorsk (2019)

N

Example

Useless smudges

Moscow Gen 2 (2011)

N

99.99% of this is overwritten.

Example

St. Petersburg Gen 2 (2011)

NW

Similar story to Moscow, this is extremely rare coverage

Example

Siberia smudge (2013)

Randomly likes to rarely show up in the east in 2013. Maybe a pattern but undiscovered.

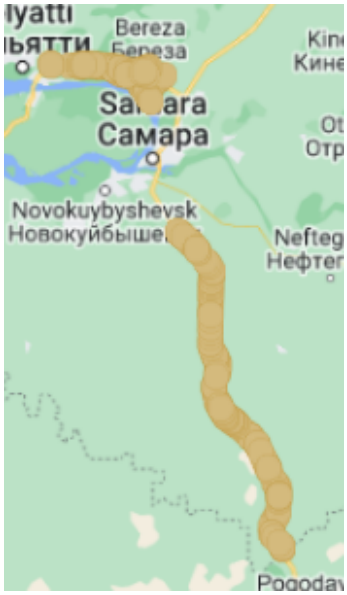
Example

Misc. related camera features

Samara red camera (2018)

SW

You get this somewhat red tint to the camera quite often in Samara. Note this is quite an unreliable meta and can be found in other places.



Example

Rostov rifts (2012)

Non-oriented

You get these rifts that are only found in downtown Rostov-on-Don. Can sometimes be single.

Example

Astrakhan rift (2015)

NW

Found mostly on a road south of the city toward the Caspian Sea, but occurs downtown as well.

Example

Resources

Practice maps

Russia short antenna smudges
Russia 2018 smudges
Russia 2019 smudges

Other documents

A Learnable Russia: Supplementary Guide
The Complete Guide To Russian Car and Seasonal Metas By BarrBarrBinks
Gas Stations of Russia

For any feedback or questions join Russiacord 🙂